

Shams Rizvi

Founder & CEO, [KnowYourCompany.ai](#) | Fractional Head of AI

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SUMMARY

Founder who built a production AI research platform end to end, from data ingestion and hybrid search to cited answers, agentic monitoring, evals and founder-led sales. Before that, 7+ years building production data and AI systems in security and financial services, including 4+ years at Concentric AI on pipelines processing 500M+ events daily. US patent co-inventor. I help early-stage founders take LLM products from demo to production: retrieval that holds up at scale, answers users can trust, and evals that show whether a change made things better.

Taking a small number of engagements: fractional Head of AI (5 to 15 hours a week) or a fixed-scope 2-week AI Production Readiness Sprint. [Book a call →](#)

SELECTED OUTCOMES

- 500M+ events processed daily in production at [Concentric AI](#), on pipelines that became core infrastructure for 32 enterprise customers
- Co-inventor on a US patent in data security, Concentric AI ([US Application No. 16/377,168](#))
- Built and shipped a production RAG platform end to end as a founding two-person team at KnowYourCompany.ai: ingestion, hybrid search, cited answers and agentic monitoring
- Shipped confidence-aware answering that declines rather than guesses on insufficient evidence, validated directly with buy-side users
- Introduced cross-site scripting protections across Barclays' core banking application suite

EXPERIENCE

Founder & CEO, [KnowYourCompany.ai](#) (VeritaForge Research Pvt Ltd)

Jan 2025 to Present | Bangalore, India

AI-native equity research platform for buy-side analysts and portfolio managers covering Indian listed companies. DPIIT-recognised startup, NVIDIA Inception member.

- Designed and built the core platform: RAG pipelines over SEBI-regulated filings (Regulation 30/33, BSE/NSE disclosures), with every answer cited to the exact filing, page and line
- Migrated retrieval from Pinecone to hybrid BM25 + semantic search on Elasticsearch (GKE), covering 5,500+ listed companies with a canonical company data model resilient to ISIN drift and corporate actions
- Built agentic change detection and monitoring: material-event alerts, filing trackers and an anomaly-first dashboard, designed from observed analyst workflows ("detect, then investigate" rather than Q&A)
- Shipped a confidence-aware answering system that declines to answer on insufficient evidence
- Took the product to market: public launch (including [Product Hunt](#)), 50+ product demos, 100+ conversations with money managers, paid pilots and evaluations with PMS, AIF and fund prospects
- Ran the company end to end: fundraising with institutional and angel investors, financial modelling, pricing, cloud cost engineering and startup credit programmes (Google Cloud, NVIDIA Inception)

Founding Engineer & Lead, [Concentric AI](#)

Aug 2020 to Dec 2024 | Bangalore, India

Data security posture management startup (AI-driven data discovery and classification).

- Built production AI systems processing 500M+ events daily, turning unstructured enterprise data into security intelligence
- Architected core data processing pipelines from 0 to 1; these became core product infrastructure serving 32 enterprise customers
- Led application development across the full stack; worked with ML teams on feature engineering and model deployment
- Ran on-call rotations and incident response for mission-critical systems
- Co-inventor on a US patent in data security ([US Application No. 16/377,168](#))

Software Developer, **Barclays** Corporate Banking

Aug 2018 to Aug 2020 | Pune, India

Built financial services applications in a highly regulated environment (compliance, security, audit).

- Built omnichannel banking applications across customer systems and payments
- Introduced cross-site scripting protections across the MCA application suite
- Worked directly with traders, analysts and relationship managers on workflow tooling

L2 Support APAC, **IBM**

Jun 2017 to Aug 2018 | Pune, India

- Provided APAC support for IBM security systems, resolving production issues for enterprise and Fortune 500 clients

EDUCATION

Graduated from Pune Institute of Computer Technology (PICT) in Computer Science, 2014 to 2018

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, Java
- **AI systems:** RAG architecture, LLM orchestration and agents (LangChain, LangGraph), embeddings, evaluation and confidence calibration, prompt engineering
- **Data and search:** Elasticsearch (hybrid BM25 + semantic), Pinecone, Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, large-scale pipeline design
- **Cloud and infra:** GCP (GKE), AWS, Azure, Modal, Temporal; cost engineering, on-call and incident response
- **Product and design:** 0-to-1 product development, user research with institutional buyers, UX prototyping (Figma, Supademo)
- **Sales and GTM:** founder-led sales (50+ product demos and 100+ conversations with India's top fund managers and analysts); HubSpot, Apollo.io, LinkedIn-based digital marketing and demand gen
- **Fundraising:** pitch narrative and deck, financial modelling, investor relations with institutional and angel investors, startup credit programmes (Google Cloud, NVIDIA Inception)
- **Domains:** financial data (SEBI/NSE/BSE disclosure regimes), enterprise data security, regulated-environment engineering

PATENTS AND RECOGNITION

- US patent, data security, Concentric AI: "Scoring identity attribute confidence while certifying authorization claims" ([US Application No. 16/377,168](#))
- KnowYourCompany.ai: DPIIT-recognised, NVIDIA Inception member; public launch on [Product Hunt](#)